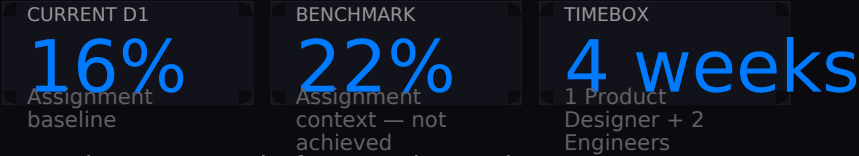


UNROT D1 RETENTION

“Designing the next reason to come back”

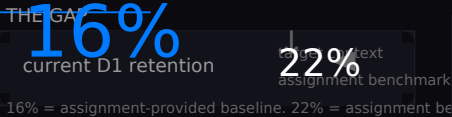


PRODUCT THESIS:
“Tomorrow’s 5-Minute Mission” — make tomorrow’s value concrete before session end

Product hypothesis + interaction prototype + experiment plan · D1 Pull package: C3 + C2 + C4 + C1
Note: 22% is the assignment benchmark provided as context. It is not a measured result, guaranteed target, or observed industry figure.

Where might Day 1 retention be breaking?

PROBLEM & DIAGNOSIS



WORKING HYPOTHESIS

New users may complete a reasonable first session but leave without a concrete reason to return.

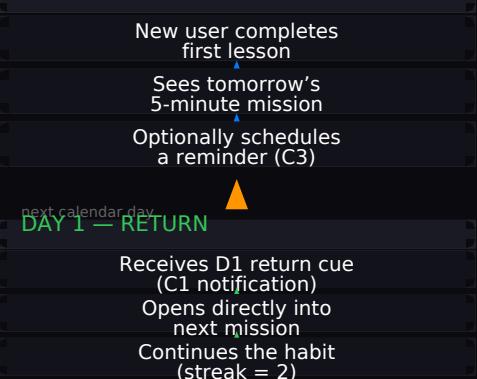
- THE SIZED MISSING PULL SIGNALS**
1. No explicit next action
 2. Weak early progress signal
 3. No strong D1 return cue

WHAT WE DON'T KNOW

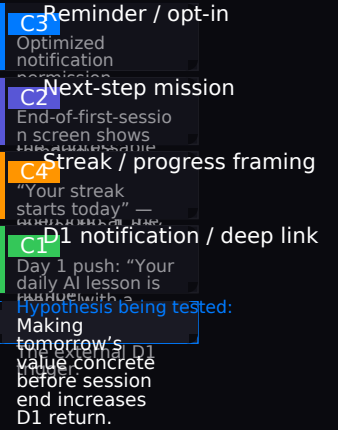
- **First-session funnel**
How many new users reach first value at all? Where is the biggest drop-off?
- **D1 by entry path**
Does D1 differ by first action — lesson vs news vs interview prep vs browse-only?
- **Notification exposure**
Are new users receiving any Day 1 prompt? What is the opt-in rate?
- **Segment-level retention**
By acquisition source, device, intent — is 16% uniform or dragged by a segment?
- **Diagnostics**
Crash rate on first session, onboarding completion, session definition, timezone handling.

TOMORROW'S 5-MINUTE MISSION

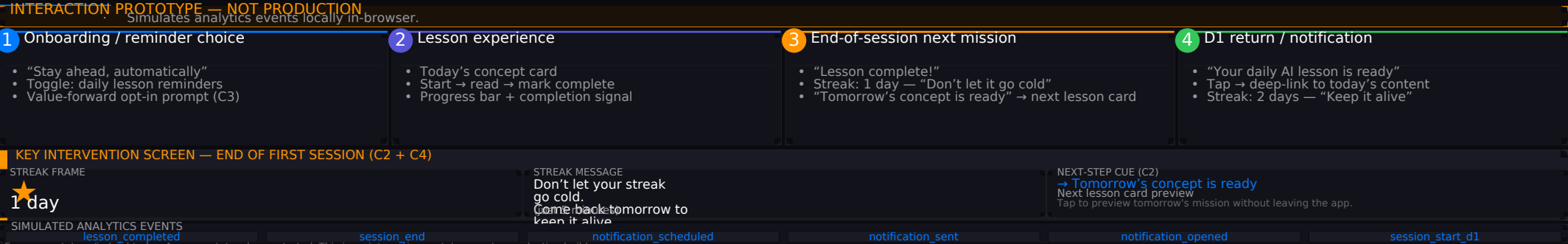
THE EXPERIENCE — FROM TODAY TO DAY 1



FOUR COORDINATED COMPONENTS



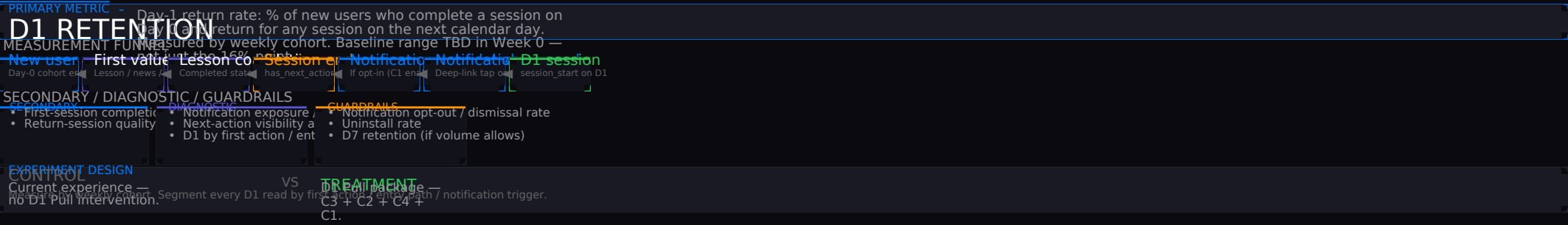
From hypothesis to interaction



CRITICAL: Browser runtime validation: BLOCKED / NOT EXECUTED in this environment. Prototype events are simulated and are NOT measured retention results.

94 MEASUREMENT & EXPERIMENT

How we'd know whether it works



Source: research/measurement-model.md, research/prd.md. No sample size or expected lift is stated — both are TBD from Week 0 cohort data.

What could prove us wrong?

FOUR COUNTER-DIAGNOSES

ACTIVATION PROBLEM New users never reach first value — low first-session completion. A return cue can't help users who never got value. Fix: activation, not D1 pull. How we'd catch it: Revealed by: first-value achievement rate (measurement model Stage 3).	AUDIENCE MISMATCH A large share of new users arrive from low-intent channels. The 16% reflects who is arriving, not what the product does. Fix: acquisition quality or onboarding qualification. How we'd catch it: Revealed by: D1-by-source segmentation.	CONTENT / VALUE PROBLEM First-session content doesn't deliver value — wrong topic, too shallow, doesn't match the user's job. A notification brings them back to the same low-value experience. How we'd catch it: Revealed by: lesson completion rate, time-in-lesson, D1-by-first-action correlation.	NOVELTY EFFECT First sessions are inflated by novelty. The 84% who don't return are users whose only motive was “I installed something new.” No push creates a return reason for them. How we'd catch it: Revealed by: D1 of high-intent cohort vs cold store traffic.
KILL / PIVOT SIGNALS × No D1 movement above baseline noise after predefined cohort reads (2+ cohorts). × Mechanism not supported by event data — e.g., D1 moves but notification-open-to-session conversion is near zero.		× Guardrail deterioration — opt-out/dismissal rise, uninstall rise, D7 drop. × Week 0 assumptions fail — “today’s lesson” can't be resolved, notification infra insufficient, first-value rate too low.	
A null result is useful: it tells us to stop optimizing the return cue and investigate the next retention mechanism.			

Test the smallest learning-rich bet

4-WEEK EXECUTION

WEEK 0	WEEK 1	WEEK 2	WEEK 3	WEEK 4
Validate assumptions + instrumentation • Lock metric definition • Instrumentation audit • Cash rate / onboarding • Establish baseline range	Build end-of-session notification + mission + reminder • Ship opt-in optimization • Build D1 notification (L) • Ship end-of-session (L)	Integrate D1 return cue • Ship D1 notification (C) • Ship end-of-session (L) • Begin weekly cohort L	Launch + monitor • First full cohort read • Segment D1 by trigger • Watch guardrails: D1	Read cohort + decide • SUCCESS: D1 moves meaningfully above baseline range with guardrails held • PROMISING: Directional lift, mechanism partly confirmed → iterate • NO IMPACT: Within baseline noise + guardrails held → kill / pivot

RECOMMENDATION
Ship the D1 Pull experiment because it directly tests the leading retention hypothesis, fits the 4-week squad constraint, and produces meaningful learning even if D1 does not move.